Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

SECOND REGULAR SESSION

RESOLUTION NO. 364

RESOLUTION HONORING THE LATE GRAND *MUFTI SHEIKH* ABUHURAIRA A. UDASAN AND EXTENDING DEEPEST CONDOLENCES AND APPRECIATION FOR HIS CONTRIBUTIONS TO THE BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION

WHEREAS, we deeply mourn the passing of *Sheikh* Abuhuraira A. Udasan, the esteemed Grand *Mufti* of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), who peacefully departed at the age of eighty-one (81) on July 3, 2023, on his residence in Lugay-Lugay, Brgy. Bagua I, Cotabato City;

WHEREAS, born on March 3, 1942, in Kitango, Municipality of Dulawan, now known as Datu Piang, Maguindanao Del Sur, *Sheikh* Abuhuraira A. Udasan pursued spiritual studies in Comparative Religion (Christian-Islam) in Jerusalem in 1966 and acquired an *"Al-Ijazah Al-Aliah"* degree from the Faculty of *Da'wah* and *Usuluddin*, specializing in comparative religion, at the Islamic University in Medina, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia (KSA), from 1967 to 1971;

WHEREAS, *Sheikh* Abuhuraira Abdulrahman Udasan is the first Bangsamoro Grand *Mufti* when the BARMM was established in 2019;

WHEREAS, concomitant with his religious and professional accomplishments, *Mufti* Udasan was fluent in multiple languages such as English, Arabic, Malay, and Tagalog. He was also proficient in various local Moro dialects which include Maguindanaon, Maranao, Iranon, and Sulug (Tausug);

WHEREAS, Grand *Mufti* Udasan served as the Director of *'Ma'had Al-Rahmaniah,'* an esteemed high school institution focusing on Islamic studies in the Arabic language, situated in Maganoy, Sharif Aguak, Maguindanao del Sur. Furthermore, he held the position of Director of Islamic *Da'wah* for the United Sabah Islamic Association in Sabah, Malaysia, for fifteen years;

WHEREAS, Grand *Mufti* Udasan was a pillar of the Bangsamoro struggle and one of the co-founders of the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF), standing alongside the late MILF Founding Chair Salamat Hashim and *Sheikh* Khalipha Usman Nando, the first *Wali* of the Bangsamoro;

WHEREAS, during the revolution, he played a pivotal role in organizing the top 300 members of the MILF;

WHEREAS, his appointment as the Grand *Mufti* of BARMM and his leadership in the Office of Bangsamoro *Darul Ifta'* (BDI) showcased his profound responsibility in issuing a *fatwa* (a ruling on a point of Islamic law) and legal opinions concerning Islamic affairs;

WHEREAS, the leadership of *Sheikh* Udasan as the Executive Director of Bangsamoro *Darul Ifta'* played an important role in implementing the Islamic concepts of conflict resolution, and other matters of social welfare in the Bangsamoro region that helped attain a community that is peaceful and harmoniously co-exists with other religions;

WHEREAS, during the surge of the COVID-19 pandemic, the Grand *Mufti* being the figurehead of the *Darul Ifta'*, made a very decisive and intellectual declaration about the permissibility or acceptability of the COVID-19 vaccines in Islam for being safe and are meant to protect the people from the said virus. He also made a declaration that being vaccinated does not nullify one's fast. Such declarations eventually led to the enlightenment of many speculations among Bangsamoro people about the COVID-19 vaccination;

WHEREAS, during his lifetime, Grand *Mufti* Udasan authored several books, including "Islam in Practice," "The Wisdom of Jihad," "The Bible of Qur'an," "Islamic *Da'wah*," "Allegations Against Islam and How I Refuted Them," and "Back to Qur'an," enriching understanding of Islam;

WHEREAS, Grand *Mufti* Udasan will be remembered as a person of unwavering integrity, dedication and compassion. His extensive knowledge of Islamic teachings and steadfast commitment to Islam made him an invaluable source of guidance and inspiration;

WHEREAS, the Bangsamoro Transition Authority joins the entire Bangsamoro region in expressing our deepest sympathies to the bereaved family, relatives and friends of Grand *Mufti* Udasan. The BTA Parliament stands united with the Bangsamoro people in mourning the loss of one of our greatest revolutionaries and religious leaders and in praying that Allah *Subhanahu Wa Ta'ala* accepts all of his good deeds, grant him forgiveness, and provide eternal solace for his soul in Jannatul Firdaus. *Inna lillahi wa inna ilayhi raji'un* (Surely, we belong to Allah and verily to Him we shall return):

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority, To honor the late Grand *Mufti Sheikh* Abuhuraira A. Udasan and extend deepest condolences and appreciation for his contributions to the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, To present this Resolution to the bereaved family of Sheikh Abuhuraira A. Udasan, for information.

ADOPTED, *Dhul Hijjah* 29, 1444/July 17, 2023.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

/Con: PR343, PR350, PR351, and PR360